ANTI-CORRUPTION COMMISSION

COMMISSION MEETING FORM

MEETING NO.	158th Commission Meeting
DATE:	3 January 2024
TIME:	02:00 PM
VENUE:	*Druk Dradhir Khang*

#	AGENDA	DISCUSSION
1	Regular HR update – HRS HRS apprised the Commission on the 128th HRC meeting as follows: - *Appeal against RCSC's decision on non-approval of Specialist promotion for Tenzin Phuntsho and defer Tashi Jamtsho's application to July 2024.*	**While the Commission noted the decisions of the HRC, the Commission directed to appeal for the specialist promotion of both Tenzin Phuntsho and Tashi Jamtsho to the RCSC. The Commission emphasized the need to justify that Tenzin Phuntsho's articles/publications and Tashi Jamtsho's system studies meet the required criteria for the promotion. This consideration is based on the rigorous process involved and the fact that the outputs are utilized by professionals and technical institutions. Furthermore, although the publications may fall under the category of agency initiatives, it is important to note that these initiatives are self-initiated. The Commission anticipates submission of many similar publications from the two candidates in the future.**
	- *Approval of application for resignation of Menuka Rai.*	**Commission was concerned and deliberated in detail on the options. Resignation should be the last absolute resort since she had expressed to the HRC Chair her intention to return after the studies as evidenced by the fact that she is leaving her child behind.**
	- *Joining of RCSC new recruits on 5 January 2024 and subsequent engagement in orientation program until May 2024.*	**Noted**
2	Monthly update on the status of Escrow Account – DoPS	**Noted and advised to ensure consistency while ascertaining penalty amount,**

	Apprised the Commission on the status of Escrow account as follows: - *Opening balance as of 1 December 2023:* ***Nu.20,504,357.53*** - *Closing balance as of 31 December 2023:* ***Nu.22,163,899.74*** *Detailed PowerPoint slides attached.*	**whether it is based on gross or basic pay.**
3	Clarification on Debarment Rule – LD & DoPS *Apprised that the Department of Procurement & Properties, MoF has debarred four consultancy firms for five years, revoked their status, and subsequently debarred them again without following due process as per the Debarment Rules 2023. This has led to confusion among the firms especially when it comes to issuing IVR.*	**Commission directed LD to lead the follow up with the MoF and bring clarity on the debarment proceedings.**
4	Involvement of RBP Personnel in corruption cases – LD & DoI *Apprised that while there have been some inconsistencies in informing the RBP Headquarter about summoning RBP personnel involved in corruption cases, it was also submitted that it would be challenging to inform RBP Headquarter on every case. Acknowledging the institutional collaboration thus far vis-à-vis the need to safeguard the integrity of the criminal investigation process, it was submitted that there is a need to establish a mutual understanding of the scenarios in which the ACC should communicate. To formalize such communication, a proposal was made to designate a focal person for this purpose.*	**Commission directed the LD to acknowledge the letter and propose for a bilateral meeting towards the third week of January 2024 to discuss on the matter. Further, advised to list out other issues or collaboration opportunities related to RBP for discussion during the meeting.**
5	Draft concept note on National Anti-Corruption Day – DoPE *Apprised that the proposal to designate His Majesty's Birth Anniversary, the 21st of February, as National Anti-Corruption Day aims to augment the commemoration of International Anti-Corruption Day every year on 9 December to raise awareness, foster a culture of integrity, and garner political will to promote ethical behavior. The commemoration kick starting from 5th February coinciding with the Birth Anniversary of His Royal Highness* the	**Commission approved the concept note with following specific comments on the list of activities to include:** - **Session on NIA and Annual Report 2022-2023 to the Members of the National Assembly.** - **Session on NIA to the Members of the National Council.** - **Session on NIA & Annual Report 2022-2023 to the CSO and Media.** **The Commission emphasized the need to expediate the submission of the note given**

	Gyalsey includes series of activities involving diverse stakeholders from all walks of life. A draft concept note and detailed activities attached.	**the limited time for preparation. An office order to this effect on the officials involved from ED, DoPE & PPD to be issued.**
6	Any others: - Letter signing Protocol – PPD	**Commission hereafter directed all Department/Division Heads to quote the Commission Meeting No. and Date in every outgoing letter.**

-Bereavement Leave-

Commissioner **Commissioner** **Chairperson**

Draft Concept Note: National Anti-Corruption Day

Background

His Majesty the Fourth King, a visionary leader decreed the establishment of the office of the Anti-Corruption Commission to prevent and combat corruption in the country. Since then, laws, policies, and awareness campaigns have been proactively steered to reduce corruption in the country. The Royal Decree of 31st December 2005 is an unswerving motivation to strive towards building a happy, harmonious, and corruption-free Bhutan.

At present, His Majesty The King has been relentlessly spearheading the fight against corruption. The strategic direction and the significance placed upon anti-corruption initiatives by His Majesty have greatly empowered the Commission to strike down the ill effects of corruption. One such activity is the commemoration of International Anti-Corruption Day on the 9th of December. The day is an opportunity to raise awareness and enlist support for anti-corruption initiatives.

Along the same line, to honor this collective effort of the past and the present, the Commission proposes designating His Majesty's Birth Anniversary, the 21st of February as National Anti-Corruption Day. This day will serve as a celebration of the legacies of Their Majesties and continue the momentum to contribute towards Developed Bhutan where the zeal to fight corruption resonates in every Bhutanese. It is a dedication to reinforce the compelling responsibility shouldered by every Bhutanese.

Objectives

1. Raise awareness, foster a culture of integrity, and garner political will to promote ethical behavior.
2. Promote and celebrate the values of integrity, transparency, and ethical conduct across all sectors of Bhutanese society.

Key Activities

Launch Event:

- An official launch event featuring prominent speakers, including government officials, and representatives from civil society organizations and youth.
- Presentation of the goals and significance of National Anti-Corruption Day
- Launch social media campaigns, interactive posts, and infographics to engage the public in discussions about Anti-corruption

Workshops, Seminars and Educational Programs:

- Conduct workshops and seminars on ethics, integrity, and professionalism for local government officials, members of civil society, students, and private sector employees.
- Collaborate with organizations to coordinate activities and facilitate discussions to address ethical challenges and solutions.
- Conduct school-based programs to educate students on the importance of Integrity and responsible citizenship.
- Develop integrity-related content to embed in educational programs and train leaders on the implementation

Community Engagement:

- Conduct social works and community bonding campaigns based on an anti-corruption theme
- Encourage citizens to share their thoughts, stories, and commitments to upholding ethical values.

Partnerships:

- Seek partnerships with government agencies, educational institutions, civil society organizations, and the private sector to ensure a comprehensive and inclusive approach to National Anti-Corruption Day.

Culmination Event:

- Host a closing ceremony to celebrate the achievements of the build-up programs.
- Recognize individuals, organizations, and initiatives that have demonstrated exemplary commitment to integrity.

Annexure

Theme: **"People Progress Prosperity: Our shared responsibility"**

Activities

- Day 1 (5th February): Introduction to National Anti-Corruption Day build-up
- Day 2 (6th February): Integrity poll
- Day 3 (7th February): Training of Trainers for DAMTSI handbook
- Day 4 (8th February): Training of Trainers for DAMTSI handbook
- Day 5 (9th February): Session with RIM
- Day 6 (10th February): Ending the year, ending corruption (chu nyipa losar special), anti-corruption message to all sim card holders
- Day 7 (11th February): Note of Appreciation (Newsletter on agencies that have integrity promotion initiatives), Best practices story /Stories of Integrity (BBS)
- Day 8 (12th February): Target specific session with LG leaders
- Day 9 (13th February): Target specific session with LG leaders
- Day 10 (14th February): Love beyond roses and chocolates, A love for your country with corruption resiliency (a poetry competition)
- Day 11 (15th February): Youth Model (s)
- Day 12 (16th February): Youth Integrity report, session with RIM
- Day 13 (17th February): 'I stand for a corrupt free Bhutan'
- Day 14 (18th February): Meet with youth leaders (18th Scouts leadership training)
- Day 15 (19th February): Airing IEC- Why youths matter in the fight against corruption
- Day 16 (20th February): Mascot

Main day (21st February):

1. Conclusion of the activities
2. Message from the Chairperson
3. Song featuring Anti-corruption message

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